

“A FLAGRANT VIOLATION OF INTERNATIONAL LAW.”

UN Security Council, on the US invasion of Grenada in 1983



2:5 **Falklands casualties**
During the Falklands War, which lasted 74 days, 255 British and 649 Argentine soldiers were killed. More than 11,000 Argentine soldiers were taken prisoner.

part of three Iraqi divisions. Iranian president **Ali Khamenei** (b. 1939) rejected an Iraqi offer of a ceasefire and sent thousands of young Iranians to their death in “human-wave” attacks that cleared the way for Iranian tanks. However, by the year’s end, Iraq had been resupplied with new **Soviet arms**, and the ground war entered a new phase (see 1983).



King of pop

The dominant pop star of the 80s, **Michael Jackson** released the album *Thriller* in 1982. It became, and remains, the best-selling album of all time.

Solidarity (see 1981), the Polish Trade Union Movement, was **banned by the Polish government** on October 8. This was greeted by

Israel invaded **Lebanon** on June 6, in an attempt to wipe out **guerrilla positions** on Israel’s northern border. By September 15, the Israeli army occupied West Beirut. On September 16–18, the **Phalangists**, loyal to Israel, killed hundreds of Palestinians in refugee camps. Defense minister **Ariel Sharon resigned** after an Israeli inquiry stated he had failed to act to prevent the massacre.

The **IRA** continued their campaign against British rule in Northern Ireland by exploding **two bombs** in London parks. The first, at **Hyde Park**, killed four soldiers from the Household Cavalry. Horses were also slain. The second, placed underneath the bandstand in **Regents Park**, killed seven soldiers.

Israel attacks Lebanon

Many cities were bombarded by heavy artillery during the Israeli invasion of Lebanon – an attempt to drive out the PLO.

international condemnation and street protests. US President Ronald Reagan put pressure on Poland by imposing economic sanctions. **Lech Walesa** (b. 1943), the Solidarity leader, was released on November 12, after 11 months of internment.

Leonid Brezhnev (b. 1906), leader of the Soviet Union, died on November 10. He had served as general secretary for 18 years. He was succeeded by **Yuri Andropov** (1914–84). During his leadership, Brezhnev had pushed for better relations with the West, and increased Soviet military and industrial strength, but living standards remained poor.

The world’s **first test tube twins** were born in Manchester, England, on April 28. The twins were conceived outside the womb after their mother underwent in-vitro fertilization (IVF).

ON JANUARY 17, NIGERIA

ANNOUNCED that it would **expel all resident aliens**. Over a million foreigners were forced out. The move was condemned abroad, but appeared popular in Nigeria.

Drought struck Ethiopia this year. Harvests failed and there were massive food shortages. The crisis was exacerbated by the communist government’s military spending and censorship of the emerging crisis.

The **US embassy in Beirut** was hit by a suicide bomber on April 19. The US government believed the attack was carried out by **Hezbollah**, a militant Islamic group. Later in the year, terrorists bombed the French and American peacekeeping headquarters in Beirut, with extensive loss of life.

In the **Iraq-Iran War**, Iraq had begun using **chemical weapons** – the blister agent mustard gas was deployed as Iraq fought back against attacks from the “human waves” of Iranian troops.

Vicious attacks were carried out against members of the **Tamil** ethnic group in **Sri Lanka** on



Secret hunger

A mother holds her child during the Ethiopian famine. The Ethiopian government initially hid the famine from the rest of the world.

July 23. These followed a deadly ambush by **Tamil Tigers**, which killed 13 Sri Lankan soldiers. The year marked the start of **civil war**.

The **Soviets** were accused of **shooting down a Korean airliner** on September 1. They claimed the airliner flew into their airspace and did not respond to communication.

President Reagan had spearheaded a strategy to support **anticommunist insurgencies** bent on overthrowing Marxist regimes. In May, Reagan openly expressed support for the **Contras**, the Nicaraguan opposition to **Communist Sandinista** rule. In October, the US overthrew the Marxist government of **Grenada**.

On March 23, President Reagan launched his **Strategic Defence Initiative** (SDI), an ambitious scheme to combat nuclear weapons in space. Reagan’s SDI became known as “**Star Wars**.”

\$20 BILLION
THE PROPOSED
COST OF
“STAR WARS”

